

DIGITAL FORENSICS & INCIDENT RESPONSE

HOST DFIR REPORT

Comparative analysis of Microsoft Defender investigation packages

Document field	Value
Host	corp-dc01 (CORP-DC01)
Host IP	10.3.0.45
Report date	2026-08-14
Classification	Confirmed security-relevant host activity; source attribution correlated from MDE telemetry
Earlier collection	2026-07-30T18:55:56Z
Later collection	2026-08-11T22:10:27Z

Scope: This report compares two Microsoft Defender investigation packages from corp-dc01. "Not found" means not found within those packages and does not establish that the activity did not occur. Microsoft Defender Advanced Hunting and MySQL audit evidence are addressed in the companion incident response report.

Verdict: High-confidence security-relevant activity occurred after the earlier collection. When correlated with the supplied MDE exports, an external RemoteInteractive administrator logon was followed by Octo Browser download, installation, execution, a Defender path exclusion, and outbound Octo traffic. The credential-acquisition method and ultimate host objective are not determined from available logs.

Document relationship: This is a host-focused companion to the broader Windows/MySQL incident response report. Package-only findings do not negate the independently confirmed MySQL destructive and ransom activity.

1. Scope, Baseline, and Method

The earlier package is the chronological baseline because its internal collection timestamp precedes the later package. It is not treated as pristine: the earlier Security log records joedizon creating the local administrator account and adding it to Administrators and Remote Desktop Users shortly before collection (EventRecordIDs 27530, 27549, and 30357).

Role	Archive	Collected (UTC)	Collection evidence
Earlier	PreBreach_MDE_Investigation_Package.zip	2026-07-30T18:55:56Z	Forensics Collection Summary.csv:2
Later	Not determined from available report	2026-08-11T22:10:27Z	Forensics Collection Summary.csv:2

Continuity note: both package summaries identify CORP-DC01 and 10.3.0.45. A separately cited OS-installation continuity value was not present in the source report.

Time standard: All report times are UTC. Defender CSV timestamps displayed in Pacific Daylight Time were normalized to UTC (UTC+7) for cross-source correlation.

2. Correlated Host Timeline

UTC	Event	Source
2026-07-30 18:55:56	Earlier package collected	Collection Summary.csv:2
2026-08-01 23:04:26	Successful external RemoteInteractive administrator logon from 149.88.100.43	DeviceLogonEvents
2026-08-01 23:06:42	Octo_Browser_latest_win.exe written to administrator Downloads; SHA-256 recorded	DeviceFileEvents
2026-08-01 23:07:02	Octo installer executed as administrator	DeviceProcessEvents
2026-08-01 23:10:56	Octo Browser 3.0.7 uninstall/product registry entries created	DeviceRegistryEvents
2026-08-01 23:11:07	Defender exclusion added for the Octo Browser bin path	DeviceRegistryEvents
2026-08-01 23:17:36	Octo Browser connected to app.octobrowser.net over TCP/443	DeviceNetworkEvents
2026-08-07 20:56:42	Octo BAM timestamp confirms later execution	Autoruns/Autoruns.txt:1783-1800
2026-08-11 22:10:27	Later package collected	Collection Summary.csv:2

Correlation assessment: The 149.88.100.43 logon preceded the installer file event by 2 minutes 16 seconds. This temporal sequence is strongly consistent with hands-on-keyboard activity during the external administrator session; the method used to obtain the administrator credential is not determined.

3. Package Comparison Findings

Delta labels are normalized to ADDED, REMOVED, CHANGED, UNCHANGED, or Not determined from available logs.

3.1 Security-Relevant Software and Control Changes

Artifact	Delta	Assessment	Finding and evidence
Octo Browser 3.0.7	ADDED	Suspicious in context	Present in the later package and absent from the earlier package. Installed during the externally correlated administrator session. Evidence: Post/Installed Programs/InstalledPrograms.csv:13.
Octo installer and execution	ADDED	Suspicious in context	Octo_Browser_latest_win.exe was observed, installed, and executed. Evidence: MPScanSkip-20260711-210425.log:102; application.evtx EventRecordIDs 1132 and 1144-1145; MPLog-20260711-210425.log:22017-22020; MDE File/Process exports.
Defender Octo path exclusion	ADDED	Confirmed defense-evasion behavior	Exclusion: C:\Users\administrator\AppData\Roaming\Octo Browser\bin. Added 2026-08-01 23:11:07Z. Evidence: MPOperationalEvents.txt:7878-7881; MPSupportEffectiveConfig.json:2141-2157; MPRegistry.txt:208-209; MDE Registry export.
App Control user-mode policy	CHANGED	Security-relevant; cause unknown	Changed from Audit to Off. No telemetry identifies the actor or establishes malicious intent. Evidence: Earlier and later System Information/SystemInformation.txt:52.
Octo BAM and Prefetch	ADDED	Suspicious in context	Confirms Octo execution by 2026-08-07T20:56:42Z. Actor intent is not determined. Evidence: Autoruns/Autoruns.txt:1783-1800; PrefetchFilesList.txt:145.

3.2 Accounts, Authentication, and Event Coverage

Artifact	Delta	Assessment	Finding and evidence
Local group membership	UNCHANGED	Risky baseline state	Files are identical. Administrators include administrator and joedizon; administrator and Guest were already Remote Desktop Users. No later privileged-account creation was identified. Evidence: LocalGroups.txt:12-21 and 156-165.
External administrator session	ADDED	High significance	A successful RemoteInteractive administrator logon from 149.88.100.43 occurred at 2026-08-01 23:04:26Z, immediately before the Octo sequence. Evidence: DeviceLogonEvents.csv; System Event 7001, EventRecordID 1333.
Failed logons and lockouts	CHANGED	Confirmed attack pressure	Later Security log records 6,891 Event 4625 failures and 66 Event 4740 lockouts. Earlier log already contained 1,764 failures; attack pressure predated the baseline. The failed sources are not linked to a successful session.
Earlier Security-log window	REMOVED	Rollover; major evidence gap	Earlier EventRecordIDs 10790-30498 are absent from the later package, which covers 210220-233010. Neither package contains Event 1102; System/Application sequences are monotonic, providing no evidence of manual clearing.
35.233.110.106 type-3 event	ADDED	Hunt indicator only	One anonymous type-3 network logon was recorded (EventRecordID 213500). It is consistent with probing, but its relationship to the compromise is not determined from available logs.

3.3 Persistence, Processes, Network, and Collection Gaps

Artifact	Delta	Assessment	Finding and evidence
Updater services and tasks	ADDED	Benign / expected	Google updater services/task and administrator OneDrive/SoftLanding tasks are consistent with Chrome installation and first login. No Octo Run key, service, or scheduled task was found. Evidence: Services.csv:68-70; ScheduledTasks.csv:5-12 and 309-313; Autoruns.txt:7444-7470.
Defender KslD.sys driver	ADDED	Likely benign	Consistent with a Defender component/update. Evidence: Autoruns.txt:8762-8768; System Event 7045, EventRecordID 1644.
Interactive GUI process snapshot	REMOVED	Benign snapshot difference	The earlier package contained an active joedizon RDP session; the later point-in-time snapshot did not. No loaded-module inventory was supplied. Evidence: Users and Groups/QueryUser.txt:1-2.
Core listeners	UNCHANGED	Exposure unchanged	Listeners 135, 445, 3306, 3389, 5040, 7680, and 33060 remained present. No Octo connection existed at the later collection instant; separate MDE telemetry records earlier Octo outbound connections. Evidence: ActiveNetConnections.txt:5-21.
DNS, hosts, firewall, startup	Not determined	Evidence gap	Later DNS cache could not be displayed. Hosts file, firewall-rule export, and startup-folder inventory were not collected. Their absence is not evidence of clearing.
Browser and credential artifacts	Not determined	Evidence gap	Browser history/cookies and credential stores were not supplied; browser intent, account use, and possible credential access cannot be established from the packages.

Routine OpenOffice and Visual C++ additions on 2026-08-08 were assessed as benign (InstalledPrograms.csv:6, 8, and 10).

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Mappings distinguish confirmed behavior from techniques that require additional attribution.

Technique	Confidence	Evidence basis	Limitation
T1562.001 - Impair Defenses	High for behavior	Defender path exclusion reduced scanning coverage for the Octo directory.	Actor attribution is correlated, not proven solely by the registry event.
T1110 - Brute Force	High for attempts	Thousands of failed authentications and lockouts demonstrate repeated password attacks.	Does not establish which source, if any, obtained valid credentials.
T1078.003 - Local Accounts	High with MDE correlation	An external RemoteInteractive session successfully used the local administrator account.	The source IP is outside the rolled-over package Security window.
T1133 - External Remote Services	High with MDE correlation	External RemoteInteractive access to the host is confirmed in DeviceLogonEvents.	Package-only evidence does not preserve the originating authentication event.
T1105 - Ingress Tool Transfer	Possible	The Octo installer was written to administrator Downloads through a browser process.	The evidence does not independently prove an adversary-controlled transfer source.

5. Observed Artifacts and Hunt Indicators

5.1 Confirmed or Correlated Host Artifacts

Type	Value	Status	Context
File	Octo_Browser_latest_win.exe	Observed - high	Administrator Downloads; executed and deleted after launch
SHA-256	83efc72d3a3e1272037188fd7a208039f4ec7c7add073d4a2b3a112e169e58dd	Observed - high	Installer hash from DeviceFileEvents; not derived from a package-collected executable
Executable / Prefetch	Octo Browser.exe; OCTO BROWSER.EXE-0FA47362.pf	Observed - high	Present later; absent earlier
Install path	C:\Program Files\Octo Browser\	Observed - high	Later package and MDE registry evidence
Defender exclusion	C:\Users\administrator\AppData\Roaming\Octo Browser\bin	Observed - high	Added 2026-08-01 23:11:07Z
Publisher / product	Blackbird Secure Browsing LTD; {EE009A99-B7A6-404B-83C8-DB5632CB216C}	Observed - high	Later uninstall/product metadata
Outbound domains	app.octobrowser.net; app01.octobrowser.net; app.obiwankenode.com	Observed - high	Confirmed Octo process connections in DeviceNetworkEvents
External RDP sources	80.66.83.80; 79.124.58.202; 149.88.100.43; 180.120.118.31	Observed - high	Successful RemoteInteractive administrator logons

5.2 Contextual and Failed-Only Hunt Indicators

Type	Value	Status	Context
Metadata domains	octobrowser.net; docs.octobrowser.net; t.me/octobrowser_chat	Contextual	Present as vendor/uninstall metadata; package evidence does not prove contact
Failed-logon sources	94.26.68.54; 109.205.211.101; 77.90.185.253; 194.49.79.65	Failed-only	1,669 / 733 / 653 / 639 failures; no successful access attributed
Anonymous network source	35.233.110.106	Relationship unknown	One anonymous type-3 logon; consistent with probing but not proven compromise

Interpretation: Octo Browser is not classified as malware by the available evidence. It is security-relevant because it was installed during a correlated external administrator session, followed by a Defender exclusion and outbound traffic. Failed-only IPs and metadata-only domains must not be presented as confirmed compromise sources.

6. Probable Incident Type and Evidence Gaps

Probable incident type: hands-on-keyboard compromise or unauthorized use of a privileged local account, followed by installation of anti-detect browser tooling and a reduction of Defender coverage for the Octo directory. External RDP access is confirmed in MDE telemetry, but how the administrator

credentials were obtained is not determined from available logs. The ultimate host objective is not determined.

Package-level impact boundary: The investigation packages contain no evidence of endpoint ransomware, credential dumping, lateral movement, exfiltration, or destructive host impact. This does not contradict the companion incident report, which documents destructive and ransom-related MySQL activity from separate audit evidence.

- The later package archive filename is not identified in the available source report.
- Security.evtx does not cover 2026-07-31 through 2026-08-09, including the Octo installation window.
- No RDP operational logs, executable payload, package-derived hashes, or loaded-module inventory were supplied.
- No browser history/cookies, credential stores, hosts-file capture, startup-folder inventory, or firewall-rule export was supplied.
- Process and network artifacts in the packages are point-in-time snapshots; absence at collection does not establish absence earlier.
- The later DNS cache could not be displayed, limiting domain-level attribution from the package alone.

7. Recommended Disposition

- Reimage corp-dc01 from a known-good source because multiple external administrator sessions and security-control changes occurred.
- Rotate the local administrator credential and any Windows, MySQL, application, or stored secrets exposed on the host.
- Remove the Octo Browser software and Defender exclusion only after evidence preservation if immediate reimaging is not possible.
- Deny direct Internet access to RDP and MySQL; require VPN, Azure Bastion, JIT access, and explicit source allowlists.
- Retain Security, RDP Operational, Defender, network-flow, and browser telemetry long enough to cover the full incident window.

8. Evidence Referenced

Source	Use
Investigation packages	Forensics Collection Summary.csv; InstalledPrograms.csv; Autoruns.txt; PrefetchFilesList.txt; LocalGroups.txt; QueryUser.txt; Services.csv; ScheduledTasks.csv; ActiveNetConnections.txt; Security/System/Application logs; Defender support artifacts
DeviceLogonEvents.csv	External RemoteInteractive administrator successes and source IPs
DeviceFileEvents(2).csv	Octo installer creation/deletion and SHA-256
DeviceProcessEvents(2).csv	Installer execution and Octo Browser processes
DeviceRegistryEvents(2).csv	Octo installation metadata and Defender path exclusion
DeviceNetworkEvents(2).csv	Octo outbound domains and remote IP connections
Companion incident report	MySQL destructive/ransom activity and broader incident-response findings
MITRE ATT&CK	Official technique pages for T1562.001, T1110, T1078.003, T1133, and T1105

Package-specific line and EventRecordID citations were retained from the source DFIR analysis. Findings not supported by the supplied MDE exports remain package-scoped.

End of report. Findings are limited to the cited evidence; absence of an event is not proof that the activity did not occur.